

Course Bid Point Allocation

Concept Note

How your bid points are calculated for the upcoming enrolment cycle

From the upcoming enrolment cycle, registration for elective courses will move from a first-come, first-served process to a bid-point system. This note explains how bid points are calculated, how they are allocated across different batches, and the rationale behind the allocation.

1. The idea, in brief

Bid points are a budget that you use to compete for elective courses - Major Electives (ME), University-Wide Electives (UWE), and Common Core Courses (CCC). Core and other mandatory degree-completion courses are pre-enrolled and are not part of the bidding process.

Your bid-point allocation is based on two guiding principles:

- **Need-scaled:** Your allocation scales with the credits you still need to complete in each category. The more credits you have remaining, the more bid points you receive.
- **Seniority-preserving:** Senior batches receive larger bid-point allocations, preserving the priority that previously existed through staggered registration windows. Under the new system, this priority is expressed through bid points rather than earlier access to the registration portal.

There is no minimum bid. You may bid any whole number of points, including zero. All students remain subject to the University's 25-credit-per-semester enrolment limit, and any unused bid points automatically carry forward to future semesters.

2. Second-year students - the steady-state model

This is the long-term allocation model that will apply to all future batches following the new curriculum.

How it works

Each academic credit is assigned a value of 10 bid points.

For every elective category, your total degree requirement determines the overall bid-point pool:

- Major Electives: If 36 credits -> 360 points; If 20 credits -> 200 points
- University-Wide Electives: 16 credits + half of the Floater credits -> $16 \times 10 + (8/2) \times 10 = 200$ points
- Common Core Courses: 12 credits (excluding the mandatory 4-credit EVS requirement) + half of the Floater credits -> $12 \times 10 + (8/2) \times 10 = 160$ points

These pools are released semester by semester, with a greater proportion allocated during the earlier semesters to provide flexibility to either bid immediately or save points for later.

For the first bidding cycle (Semester 3), the allocation is:

- Major Electives: 63 points
- UWE: 40 points
- CCC: 28 points

In addition, students will receive the unused bid points allocated for Semester 2 as carry-forward. For every credit already completed in Semester 1 or Semester 2 (excluding EVS), **5 points are deducted** from the relevant category so that the allocation accurately reflects the credits still remaining.

Category	Sem 1	Sem 2	Sem 3	Sem 4	Sem 5	Sem 6	Sem 7	Sem 8	Total
Major Electives	0	27	63	72	72	72	54	0	360
UWE	0	30	40	40	40	30	20	0	200
CCC	0	12	28	32	32	32	24	0	160

Semester-wise release schedule

Category	Sem 2	Sem 3	Sem 4	Sem 5	Sem 6	Sem 7	Total
UWE	15%	20%	20%	20%	15%	10%	100%
ME / CCC	7.5%	17.5%	20%	20%	20%	15%	100%

Worked example - second-year student (Semester 3)

Assume a student completed 3 UWE credits in Semesters 1-2, completed no ME or CCC credits (apart from EVS), and has not previously spent any bid points. The Semester 2 allocation is carried forward and the completed UWE credits are deducted at 10 points per credit.

Category	Calculation	Points
ME	Semester 2 carry-forward 27 + Semester 3 release 63 - 0 completed-credit deduction	90
UWE	Semester 2 carry-forward 30 + Semester 3 release 40 - (3 credits x 5)	55
CCC	Semester 2 carry-forward 12 + Semester 3 release 28 - 0 completed-credit deduction	40

Result: The student begins the Semester 3 bidding cycle with 90 ME points, 40 UWE points and 40 CCC points. EVS is excluded from the CCC deduction.

Why it is designed this way

Since second-year students - and all future batches - will spend their entire degree under the bidding system, their bid points are released gradually in proportion to their remaining degree requirements. The front-loaded schedule provides flexibility to spend points early or conserve them for future semesters while maintaining the University's credit-based choice model.

3. Third-year students - the transition model (Semesters 5-7)

The current third-year batch is already midway through its programme. Accordingly, in addition to the credit-based allocation, students receive a one-time transition allocation that preserves the seniority advantage they would have enjoyed under the previous registration system.

How it is calculated

For each category:

- Major Electives: (Remaining Credits x 10 x Semester Share) + 65
- University-Wide Electives: (Remaining Credits x 10 x Semester Share) + 50
- Common Core Courses: (Remaining Credits x 10 x Semester Share) + 30

Floater credits are divided equally between UWE and CCC before calculating the allocation.

How it is awarded

The credit-based component is distributed across the remaining three semesters in the ratio 40 : 30 : 30 (Semesters 5, 6 and 7). The transition constant is added in full during each of these semesters.

Based on current University records, on an average a third-year student has 20 Major Elective credits, 7.5 UWE credits, 7.5 CCC credits and 6 Floater credits remaining. This results in the following allocation:

Category	Semester 5	Semester 6	Semester 7	Total
Major Electives	145	125	125	395
UWE	92	82	82	256
CCC	72	62	62	196

These allocations are fixed for the transition and will not be recalculated in later bidding cycles.

Worked example - third-year student (Semester 5)

Assume a third-year student has 24 ME credits, 9 UWE credits, 6 CCC credits and 6 Floater credits remaining. The Floater credits are divided equally, adding 3 credits each to UWE and CCC. The effective balances are therefore 24 ME, 12 UWE and 9 CCC credits.

Category	Calculation	Points
ME	$(24 \text{ remaining credits} \times 10 \times 40\%) + 65$	161
UWE	$((9 \text{ UWE} + 3 \text{ Floater}) \times 10 \times 40\%) + 50$	98
CCC	$((6 \text{ CCC} + 3 \text{ Floater}) \times 10 \times 40\%) + 30$	66

Result: The student receives 161 ME points, 98 UWE points and 66 CCC points for Semester 5. For Semesters 6 and 7, the same remaining-credit base is multiplied by 30%, with the full transition constant added each semester.

Why the transition constant exists

Without the transition constant, allocations would depend solely on remaining credits. This would result in some third-year students receiving fewer bid points than second-year students during the first bidding cycle and would inadvertently disadvantage students who proactively completed electives early - for example, to pursue a minor, a specialisation, or a balanced academic workload.

The transition constant restores a clear seniority advantage while ensuring that the credit-based component continues to reflect individual remaining requirements. No bid points will be allocated during Semester 8 (Spring 2028). All calculated bid-point allocations are rounded to the nearest whole number.

4. Fourth-year students - the transition model (Semester 7)

The graduating batch receives the strongest transition support because it planned its entire academic journey under the previous registration system and now needs to complete any remaining requirements during its final year.

How it is calculated

For each category:

- Major Electives: $(\text{Remaining Credits} \times 15) + 162$
- University-Wide Electives: $(\text{Remaining Credits} \times 15) + 110$
- Common Core Courses: $(\text{Remaining Credits} \times 30) + 72$

Floater credits are split equally between UWE and CCC. Bidding applies only in Semester 7. No bid points are allocated for Semester 8.

Based on current University records, on an average a fourth-year student profile - 9 ME credits, approximately 0 UWE credits, 5.5 CCC credits and 6 Floater credits remaining - the allocation becomes:

Category	Semester 7	Minimum Allocation
Major Electives	297	162
UWE	125	110
CCC	239	72

Worked example - fourth-year student (Semester 7)

Assume a fourth-year student has 12 ME credits, 4 UWE credits, 6 CCC credits and 6 Floater credits remaining. Splitting the Floater credits equally gives effective balances of 12 ME, 7 UWE and 9 CCC credits.

Category	Calculation	Points
ME	$(12 \text{ remaining credits} \times 15) + 162$	342
UWE	$((4 \text{ UWE} + 3 \text{ Floater}) \times 15) + 110$	215
CCC	$((6 \text{ CCC} + 3 \text{ Floater}) \times 30) + 72$	342

Result: The student receives 342 ME points, 215 UWE points and 342 CCC points for the Semester 7 bidding cycle. No additional bid points are awarded in Semester 8.

Why these allocations are higher

Fourth-year students receive a higher per-credit value (15 points) than junior batches, together with larger transition constants that act as a guaranteed minimum allocation. Consequently, even students who have already completed most requirements retain a meaningful bidding pool during their final year.

The CCC multiplier is doubled to 30 points per credit because CCC courses typically carry only about 1.5 credits, roughly half the size of a standard elective. Doubling the multiplier ensures that each additional CCC course still translates into a comparable increase in bid points. This is particularly important because many fourth-year students seek to complete their remaining CCC requirements before internships and other final-year commitments.

5. Provisions applicable to all students

- **There is no minimum or maximum bid.** Students may bid any whole number, including zero.
- 25 credit limit per semester applies for all students.
- Every course has a single clearing price. Students who receive a seat pay only the lowest successful bid, irrespective of the amount they actually bid. Any excess bid points, as well as unsuccessful bids, are automatically refunded. Courses with vacant seats will have a clearing price of zero.
- Unused bid points automatically carry forward to future bidding semesters.
- The University's 25-credit-per-semester enrolment limit continues to apply to all students. Larger bid-point allocations therefore provide greater prioritisation flexibility but cannot be used to accumulate excessive course registrations.
- Core and other mandatory degree-completion courses, including compulsory re-takes of failed core courses, remain outside the bidding process.
- Students with failed grades in core courses would be required to fill a separate google form for core courses enrolment to clear previous failed courses.
- Students re-taking an elective course after receiving any of the Fail (F/Ab/F*) grade must submit a fresh bid for that course. **If the attendance requirement has been met in the previous attempt of the course (i.e. no Ab / F* grade),** then automatic attendance waiver applies. However, students would not be able to bid for clashing courses.
- The Course Replacement process remains unchanged. A Google Form will be circulated after the final Add/Drop deadline.
- Requests for Grade Improvement (for both elective and major core courses) will be collected through a separate Google Form during the Add/Drop period. Grade Improvement registrations will be processed only if seats remain available and there are no timetable clashes with already confirmed enrolments.
- Special enrolments like for Course Audit, Enrolment in master's level courses, and so on will be handled outside the course bidding process.

**Best Wishes,
Ankur**